

Yes -- Chris Squire Signature Bass Tone

Chris Squire is the reason "bright, driven bass" is a genre unto itself.

Rickenbacker 4001 into a split rig -- one side clean, one side cranked -- blended back together.

Pick attack up front, mids pushed for that vocal "growl," top end left wide open.

No scoop. This is not a modern hi-fi bass tone -- it's aggressive and present, sitting almost like a rhythm guitar in the mix.

This patch models that blend using the GP-5's own gain stages (boost + Bass OD, blended) instead of running two physical amps, and adds a second, cleaner CTL state for Yes's more open, arpeggiated passages (intros, builds, sections like "Roundabout"'s intro or "And You and I").

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 25
- Always on. Light gate -- just enough to clean up hiss from the boost/OD stack without chopping sustain on longer notes.

PRE -- B-Boost (Xotic BB Preamp Overdrive)

- Gain: 60, VOL: 55, Bass: 55, Treble: 65
- **CTL switch.** Off = engaged, On = bypassed.
- This is the "second amp" in Squire's split-signal trick -- a preamp push that adds grit and top-end bite ahead of the OD stage. Off state (growl) runs it engaged; On state (clean) bypasses it entirely so the clean arpeggiated tone stays uncolored.

DST -- Bass OD (bass-specific overdrive with wet/dry blend)

- Gain: 65, Blend: 60, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 70
- **CTL switch.** Off = engaged, On = bypassed.
- Blend at 60 (not maxed) keeps the fundamental intact under the drive -- this is the Blend knob doing the job Squire's amp-splitting rig did physically. Treble pushed hard (70) for the aggressive top-end snap that defines the tone. Off = the driven growl (main Yes sound). On = fully clean for open/arpeggiated sections.

AMP -- Foxy Bass (Vox AC-100)

- VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 70
- Always on, both CTL states. Squire ran Vox alongside his Marshall for the top-end snap -- Foxy Bass is the closest voicing in this catalog to that brightness. Treble pushed to keep the amp itself bright regardless of which CTL state is active.

CAB -- AMPG 4x10 (Ampeg SVT-410HE)

- VOL: 55
- Always on. Only true bass cab in the catalog -- gives the amp sim real low-end foundation under the

brightness.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +8, 150Hz: -5, 600Hz: +8, 2kHz: +12, 8kHz: +15, VOL: 50
- Always on, both states. This is the Squire signature curve: solid low-end anchor (33Hz), a dip at 150Hz to keep it from getting muddy, then a rising shelf from 600Hz up through 8kHz for the vocal midrange growl and the glassy top-end snap. Not scooped -- Squire's mids are pushed, not cut.

MOD -- B-Chorus (Boss CE-2B for Bass)

- Depth: 20, Rate: 0.8Hz, VOL: 50
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Light touch, per the usual MOD rule -- this isn't a drenched chorus tone. Off (growl state) stays dry, all the character comes from the drive. On (clean state) adds a light shimmer under the open/arpeggiated playing, which is where Yes recordings do occasionally use a touch of chorus-y width on cleaner bass parts.

DLY -- Off

Not used. Squire's tone (and Yes's studio bass sound generally) is dry -- no delay character associated with the signature tone.

RVB -- Off

Not used, on either CTL state. Keeping the bass dry and upfront -- any room/hall character on a Yes record comes from the mix, not the bass tone itself.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Driven Squire growl (main tone):** B-Boost + Bass OD both engaged, no chorus. This is the tone for verses, riffs, and anything with real drive and attack -- the core Yes bass sound.
- **CTL On -- Clean/arpeggiated:** Both gain stages bypassed, light chorus engaged. Use for intros, builds, and open sections where the part needs to breathe and shimmer instead of push.

Full Pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed, whole patch.

Squire didn't build his tone around octave layering. Leave the four octave knobs at 0 and Dry at 100 so there's no surprise if the footswitch gets bumped; footswitch stays off throughout.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged, whole patch.

- COMP: 45
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: TREBLE

Sits ahead of everything, evens out pick attack before the drive stages -- Squire played with a pick, hard, and compression is part of keeping that attack consistent without losing note-to-note evenness. TREBLE mode keeps pick attack audible feeding into the darker Ampeg-voiced cab downstream. Runs continuously through both CTL states -- it's gluing dynamics, not part of the growl/clean split.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed, whole patch.

Squire's tone is driven, not fuzzed -- a full fuzz wall would bury the note definition his lines depend on. True bypass throughout.

4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged for CTL Off (growl) sections, bypassed for CTL On (clean) sections.

- Drive: 40
- Blend: 55
- Presence: 60
- Level: 55
- Treble: 60, Middle: 55, Bass: 50
- Mid-Frequency toggle: 500Hz (bass body, not pick-attack cut)
- Bass-Shift toggle: 80Hz (tighter low end -- keeps this from stacking mud with the GP-5's own Bass OD)
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On -- useful if this patch ever gets DI'd to a board or interface
- Ground Lift: Off unless hum shows up in a given room

This is the second grit stage in the "split signal" trick -- physically bypass it for the clean CTL-on sections (step off the footswitch) so nothing colors the open/arpeggiated tone. Engage it for CTL-off growl sections; it stacks with the GP-5's own PRE/DST to build the layered, amp-splitting character of the real rig instead of relying on one gain stage alone.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed, whole patch.

The GP-5's own B-Chorus module (CTL On state) is the primary chorus voice for this patch. Per the pedal's own notes, don't run both at once -- stacking two choruses just gets mushy. True bypass throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- as detailed above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Verses / riffs / driven sections (main Yes tone):** GP-5 CTL off, Tidal Wave engaged. Comp running underneath the whole time. This is the core patch -- reach for this by default.
- **Intros / builds / open arpeggiated sections:** GP-5 CTL on, Tidal Wave bypassed (step off at the same moment you hit CTL). Comp stays on.
- Octave and Fuzz stay bypassed for the entire patch -- this build is two gain stages (PRE boost + Bass OD) plus one grit pedal (Tidal Wave), not a texture pile.